

Codi Group interview

Managing Financial Performance Across Repairs & Maintenance

Sandra Vermaak · Finance Business Partner, Repairs & Maintenance · 8 September 2026

WHAT THE DECK ARGUES

It answers all five of their questions — but its spine is a claim: **a £100m budget under pressure is a decision problem, not a reporting problem.**

Rather than describing a process for investigating, it **arrives with three evidenced hypotheses and the data test for each.** That is the difference between an answer that is competent and one that is remembered. Everything on the slides is framed as a question about Codi, never an assertion about how Codi works.

THE ROOM

Jennifer Eveleigh	Send the deck to her in advance — Jennifer.Eveleigh@codigroup.co.uk .
Tom Hirst	Currently a Finance Business Partner – R&M at Codi. Your peer or the incumbent. He will know instantly whether a technical claim is right. Pitch the detail at him — and treat him as the person most likely to correct you, which is an opportunity, not a threat.
Jonathan Watson	Third panel member.
Also on the day	30 minutes with Cath Waters on the Sova personality assessment; 30 minutes round table with the R&M team you would support — that one is about relationships and influence, not technique.
Before then	Sova personality assessment to be completed by 13 September .

TIMING

SLIDE	TARGET
1 · Title and framing	0:45
2 · Scope the number	1:20
3 · Three hypotheses	2:05
4 · Rebuild the forecast	1:35
5 · Act in order	1:35
6 · Escalate	1:25
7 · Measure and close	1:05

9 min 20 at a normal pace. 10 min 05 if you speak slowly. The script is deliberately 1,260 words so there is room to breathe and to be interrupted.

Speaker notes are in the notes pane of every slide, each with a pace mark and a running total, so you can tell mid-flight whether you are ahead or behind.

If you are running long, cut from slide 5 — the four actions can be named rather than explained. Never cut slide 3.

01 Slide by slide — the line that must land

If a slide's one line lands, that slide has done its job. Everything else is support.

#	TIME	THE LINE THAT MUST LAND
1	0:45	“A £100m budget under pressure is a decision problem, not a reporting problem.” Set the caveat here and you never have to defend it later: this is your recommended approach, not a claim about how Codi works today.
2	1:20	“£100m across ~25,000 homes is ~£4,000 per home — so this is not a responsive repairs budget.” It must span responsive, voids, cyclical, compliance and planned works, which means it straddles the revenue and capital boundary. Close with the merger question: is that boundary drawn the same way across both legacy capitalisation policies?
3	2:05	“I would not arrive with an open mind and no shape.” THE SLIDE THAT WINS IT Three hypotheses — delivery mix, regulation, price — each with a test attached. Slow down here. This is the only part of the deck a rival candidate cannot have written, and it is the part Tom Hirst will engage with.
4	1:35	“The forecast is built with budget holders, not sent to them.” Then the discipline line: the delivery forecast stays visible <i>before</i> mitigation, and a savings target is not a forecast.
5	1:35	“The order is the argument.” Protect safety, compliance and WHQS response first. Then convert capacity already bought, challenge external spend, and only then rephrase. Land the second-order effect: deferring planned work moves capitalised spend into revenue, so it hits operating surplus rather than just moving between years.
6	1:25	“A repairs overspend here touches operating surplus, interest cover and the cost of borrowing.” One neutral sentence on the Yellow viability grade and one on the £130m sustainability-linked facility. State them, draw the consequence, move on — do not dwell.
7	1:05	“The test of a dashboard is whether it changes what someone does on Monday.” Close on the written line — <i>a number the operation recognises, a forecast that stops moving, and a resident who does not have to ring twice</i> — then stop talking.

The slides carry very little text on purpose. The argument is in what you say, not what they read. Do not read the slides aloud — the panel can read faster than you can speak, and a presenter who narrates their own bullets looks like someone who has not internalised the material.

02 Every fact in the deck, and how solid it is

If you are challenged on any of these, this is what you are standing on.

CLAIM	SOURCE AND CONFIDENCE
~£4,000 per home	Your own arithmetic: their £100m scenario over ~25,000 homes. SAFE Labelled illustrative on the slide.
In-house trades team expanded ~50% (34 roles), 2024	Public Pobl announcement, pre-rebrand. SOLID Say “Pobl”, not “Codi” — the deck does.
11-lot framework for responsive repairs, voids and out-of-hours	Pobl tender notice, published December 2023; the notice itself says the contractors are “to support the internal DLO”. SOLID
WHQS hazard response in force 1 April 2026	Welsh Government written statement, 19 December 2025. Imminent harm: investigate within 24 hours, remedy within a further 24. Otherwise 10 working days then 5. All HHSRS hazards except overcrowding, where within the landlord's control. Response times must be published and reported in the WHQS return. SOLID
Sector responsive repairs inflation ~23% expected, vs ~10% in global accounts	UK sector survey commentary. CAVEAT IT UK-wide and indicative, not Welsh-specific. The notes already say so — say it out loud too.
Financial viability graded Yellow, governance retained; development and planned maintenance cited	Codi Group regulatory judgement, published July 2026 — your source, not mine. VERIFY See below.
£130m sustainability-linked facility with margin tied to environmental and social targets	Reported coverage of the Handelsbanken facility, funding retrofit and low-carbon new build. SOLID

Three things to check before you send it

- 1. Re-read the Yellow line in the judgement PDF.** I could not reach gov.wales to verify it independently, so the deck rests on your reading of the primary document. It is the single claim you would least want to get wrong in front of this panel — and the one they will know best.
- 2. Say the 23% is UK-wide.** Quoting an England-weighted survey as though it were Welsh is exactly the kind of slip a finance panel notices.
- 3. The DLO expansion is 2024, not fresh.** If someone says “we sorted that two years ago”, the answer is: “*Good — then it is not hypothesis one. Which of the other two should I be looking at?*” That reply is stronger than the hypothesis was.

A word on the Yellow grade. Raising it is the right call — it shows you have read the current judgement rather than an old one, and it is what makes slide 6 land. But keep it to one flat, factual sentence and move straight to the consequence. Anything more reads as telling them about their own organisation.

03 What they are likely to push on

The presentation sits inside a one-hour interview, so expect these to come straight after.

“You have assumed quite a lot about how we operate.”

Agree immediately. They are hypotheses with tests attached, built from public information, precisely because you did not want to assert anything about their operation. Then turn it into a question: *which of the three is closest?*

“How would you size the overspend without our data?”

You would not — you would decompose it. Volume, price, mix, productivity. Name what you would ask for on day one: the ledger, work orders and commitments, contractor call-off by lot, operative hours, and the stock condition data behind the planned programme.

“What if it is simply demand?”

Then it is a capacity and unit-cost conversation rather than a control one — and the mitigation set changes completely, because you cannot save your way out of volume. That answer shows you are not attached to your own hypothesis.

“Is rephrasing not the obvious answer?”

It is the last lever, not the first, and it is rarely a saving. It converts capitalised spend into revenue and tends to raise responsive demand later. Slide 5 already says this — say it again, plainly.

“What would you do in your first 90 days?”

Three things: walk the operation before changing a single report; get one trusted set of repairs numbers; then use it to reopen one decision currently being made on instinct.

Something very specific about their reporting, from Tom Hirst.

If you do not know, say so and ask. In front of the person who does the job, a confident guess is far more damaging than an honest question — and asking well is itself evidence you would be good to partner with.

ON THE DAY

- **Send it ahead** to Jennifer Eveleigh, as asked. The notes pane travels with the file, so tidy anything in it you would not want read.
- **Slide 3 is the one.** If you are nervous, the instinct will be to rush it. Do the opposite.
- **Let the panel interrupt.** Being taken off-script by Tom Hirst is a good sign, not a derailment — the round table later is judging exactly that.
- **Do not oversell the social purpose.** Let it show in how you talk about the trade-offs; the resident is already in the deck three times.
- **End on the close line and stop.** Silence after a strong last sentence reads as confidence.

The whole deck in one sentence, if you need it: *“I would size the number, arrive with three testable explanations rather than a process, rebuild the forecast with the people who own the spend, protect the resident before cutting anything, and escalate in terms of surplus and covenant rather than variance.”*